

TRICKLE DOWN TECH



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Qualcomm on how tech trickles down to the larger market

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We had a chat with Sachin Kalantri from Qualcomm to understand how they view the extremely competitive technology space

Q In terms of gaming, Qualcomm has two IPs, one being the GPUs in your SoCs that power all the smartphones and the second are the SoCs powering the VR headsets. The latter is stated to be the future of gaming. I wanted your take on making these devices more accessible in markets such as India, China, SEA, etc where these devices are very expensive. Do you see better-performing GPUs coming to the more budget-friendly smartphones such as the ones that sell between ₹7-15K which see the highest traction in the country?

Sachin: This question gets asked around quite a lot. And you've seen how things have transitioned over the years. Typically, you see our premium tier experiences start at the 800 series and they trickle down to the lower tiers. In terms of both, the performance and the features, we do try to bring that down i.e. the goodness of all those features down to the lower tiers. And that helps almost everyone in the ecosystem - consumers, OEMs, app developers, gamers, publishers, etc all benefit. That being said, there's always going to be a lead in terms of some of the critical features initially coming in the top tier. Because that's where the appreciation from the top-tier users and the elite gamers is much higher. And they also start evangelising those features and these features then start becoming relevant to the next tiers. So it's a collective ecosystem play, I would say, where all of us need to do our bit to try to bring those features down to the lower tiers.

To tell you the truth, we did not have the 700-series until a couple of years ago. It started with the notion that we can try to bring those premium experiences down earlier. We did that and now the 600 and 400 series devices have relatively more powerful GPUs than what we had seen, let's say, two years ago. So that's a journey that we have been undertaking for the last several years. It's not just the features, it's even about the power and performance. All these things need to be looked at collectively.

When it comes to gaming, we look at it as a collection of a number of technologies. You need to have great